English Reading & Word-Building Cards

A small, reusable set of lowercase letters and words

Print only what you need

- Choose the pages for today's letters and words. Print earlier letter-card pages too if you do not already have those cut cards.
- Keep the loose letters for later words. Later pages use both new letters and letters from earlier pages.
- Talk about a word's meaning before asking a child to read it. When checking print reading, show the word before its picture; picture recognition alone is not reading.

Page map

Start with s, a, t and p	Letter cards: page 2 | Word cards: page 3
Add i and n	Letter cards: page 4 | Word cards: pages 5–6
Add m, d, g and o	Letter cards: page 7 | Word cards: pages 8–9
Add c, k, e and u	Letter cards: page 10 | Word cards: pages 11–12

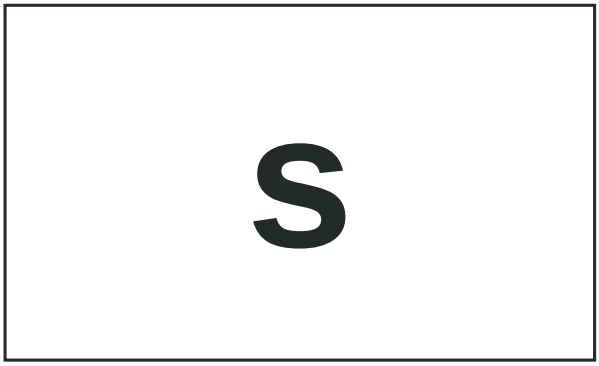
A few teaching reminders

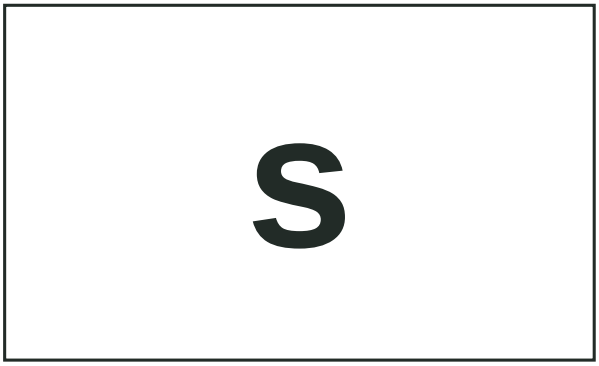
- Letter names and sounds differ. Join the sounds to read a word, rather than saying its letter names; avoid adding an extra 'uh' after consonant sounds.
- Handwriting is optional in this card game. Use the English Letter Formation Guide when helpful; these cards do not model letter formation.
- The separate English Pictures and Message Cards resource holds picture and optional message activities. This pack has no picture or sentence cards.

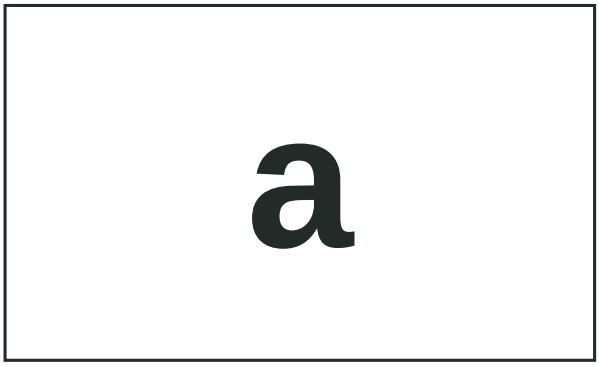
Start with s, a, t and p

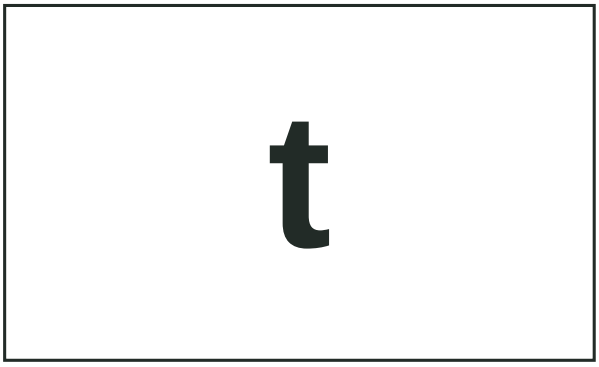
Loose letters - cut on the full borders; keep these cards for later words.

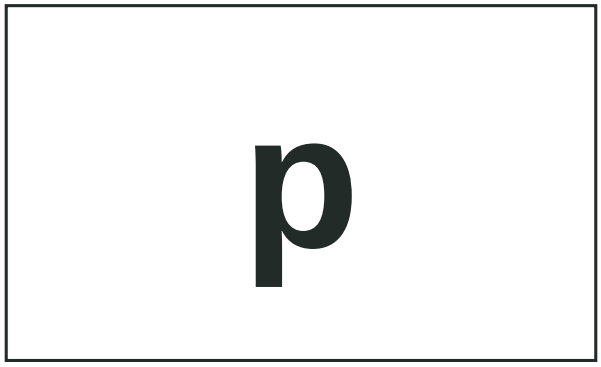
Two identical s cards are included for the letter-matching activity.











Read and build first words

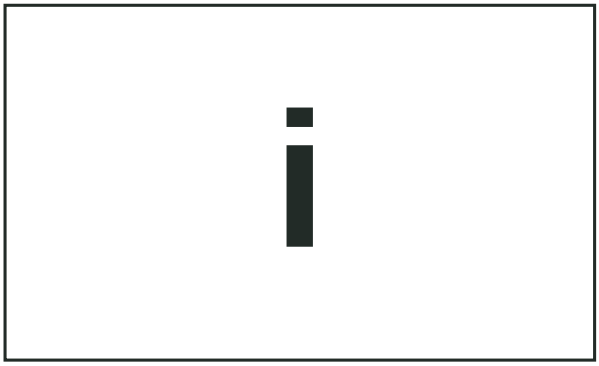
Use the letters from page 2. Talk about each word's meaning first.

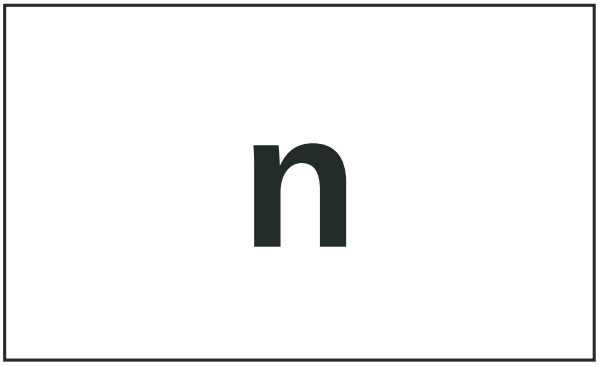
Here, pat means a gentle touch, not a person's name.

at	**sat**
pat	**tap**

Add i and n

Keep the earlier loose letters. Cut these two new cards.





Read and build more words

Use the new i and n cards with earlier letters.

Use a picture of a pin to explain its meaning. Never use a real sharp pin.

it	in
an	pin

Keep reading with i and n

Use the same loose letters; keep every cut card for later pages.

pan

sit

tip

Add m, d, g and o

Keep earlier loose letters. Cut these four new cards.

m	d
g	o

Read and build with new letters

Use these letters together with the earlier cards.

am

on

mat

map

Keep reading with new letters

Use the same loose letters and discuss what the words mean.

man	dig
dog	pot

Add c, k, e and u

Keep earlier loose letters. Cut these four new cards.

In these words, c and k can each represent /k/, but they are different letters. This pack does not teach c as /s/.

c	k
e	u

Read and build with c, k, e and u

Use new and earlier loose letters; discuss meaning before reading.

In the separate optional message cards, can means 'is able to'.

cat

cap

can

kit

kid

Keep reading with all our letters

Use the same loose letters. Choose a few useful words at a time.

pen

net

cup

sun